

A Moment In (Recent) History UFOs shadowed US Aircraft Carrier

by Jon Baughman

In the year 1958 we were on a shakedown cruise, when there was a small light that was following our ship. Then the light came right at us, it came in close enough to us so you could see the shape of the object and also see that there were figures inside of it, the impression that I got was that those figures were not human beings." -- Chester Grusinski of Clinton Twp., Michigan.

Since my series on UFOs a number of reports have been mailed to this writer. As I suspected, many of you have seen UFOs and some are only now mounting the courage to describe what you saw.

One such person is Chester Grusinski of Clinton Twp., Michigan, who served in the US Navy and in recent years has come forward to witness about UFOs. Grusinski has been featured in several Michigan newspapers and also appeared in the TV program, "Sightings." Many have doubted his story, but his determination shines through. He wants the US government to admit that there has been an intentional coverup of UFO reports and that the public deserves an explanation.

Aboard Carrier

The year was 1958. Grusinski was only 18, a crew member on the USS Aircraft Carrier Franklin D. Roosevelt, cruising the Caribbean near Cuba.

Notes Grusinski, "I was down below when I was told to go topside to see something strange," says Chester, now 56. "So I went up and couldn't believe my eyes."

"I saw a bright white ball of light. It headed straight for us, getting bigger and brighter. It was spherical, approximately 75 to 100 feet long. It turned red orange and I could feel the heat on my face."

As this was going on the man on watch was yelling into the intercom for an officer to get up on deck.

Grusinski continues, "I could see silhouettes of figures looking at us. They had no features and you could tell they weren't human. Then the bottom turned cherry red and it vanished in a flash."

Soon after the incident crew



Inset: Chester Grusinski. Bottom: USS Franklin D. Roosevelt, first Navy carrier to carry nuclear weapons.

members who talked about it were transferred. Then the CIA came on board to investigate a so-called "gambling problem."

"It was a massive coverup," notes Grusinski. "There was no gambling."

Over the years he remembered the strange sighting. Then about 1977-78 he read in a newspaper clipping that a citizens group in New York had hired a law firm to go after the CIA and the US government to release top secret UFO information. He sent them a letter about his sighting. The group attempted to get him some information with little success.

Then, Grusinski pointed out, other researchers uncovered a UFO sighting in which three photographs were taken of a flying disk, also from the USS Franklin D. Roosevelt. This was during Operation Mainbrace in which the UFO overtook the NATO fleet.

Grusinski was visiting libraries and doing research. He decided to try and locate fellow crew members who had also witnessed the 1958 event. He ran ads in *Naval Affairs* and other military magazines. Then in 1988 he learned from *DAV Magazine* about a USS FDR Reunion.

The reunion revealed that 8 to 10 separate UFO sightings were connected with this ship. He located several witnesses.

One incident took place off Rio de Janeiro, Brazil on July 26, 1956. Grusinski says, "Two disk objects were suspended in mid-air. They were over one another; they had two rows of counter-rotating lights. The upper disk released a fire ball object that dropped into the top of the lower one. Within seconds they both vanished with tremendous speed. These

were seen by Leon Treadwell, Petty Officer Third Class. All involved witnesses were told to keep a tight lip. Treadwell had to sign papers that he would tell no one for 20 years. Another one for the same time period, the 25th or 27th of July, 1956, a cigar shaped object was seen and tracked on radar. And the CIC radars said it went off the scope in two or three sweeps. That was witnessed by John C. Hau, Chief Warrant Officer."

Why were so many sightings attached to the FDR? Grusinski has his own reasons for this. He said the FDR was the first US carrier to carry nuclear weapons, and at the time, the only one to carry the hydrogen bomb. UFO sightings are common around military installations, where nuclear devices are stored. This is especially true of NATO installations.

Strangely, these incidents have been removed from the ship's logs.

The FDR was decommissioned in 1977. He says, "Myself and other UFO researchers have searched the logs; we also used the Freedom of Information Act, going as far back as 1980....I had also got a copy of the ship's deck logs from the year 1958-59; a lot of information was blackened out."

After his story appeared in *UFO Magazine*, he was contacted by *Sightings*. They also interviewed a Gunnery Officer who was a witness to the 1952 UFO sightings on the FDR. Grusinski located this man through the FDR Reunion. Overall, Grusinski felt the TV presentation was very good.

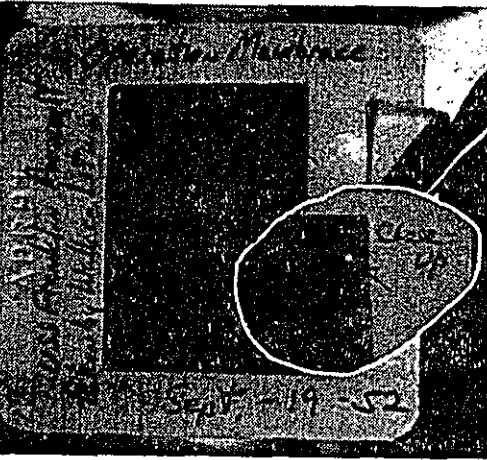
He is still looking for other witnesses who were on board the USS FDR. They may contact him at

THE BROAD TOP BULLETIN, SAXTON, PA. 16678

JOHN
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ain" compartments down below where they had a marine guard by the hatchway and they'd check your J," he said. "When they had any kind of maneuvers, anything to do with the special weapons, they canvassed it off with a heavy tarp where you couldn't see what they were doing. Years later I found out that they were nuclear weapons," Grusinski said.

While Grusinski's Freedom of Information Act requests to the Central Intelligence Agency and the National Security Agency turned up negative, the Roosevelt's



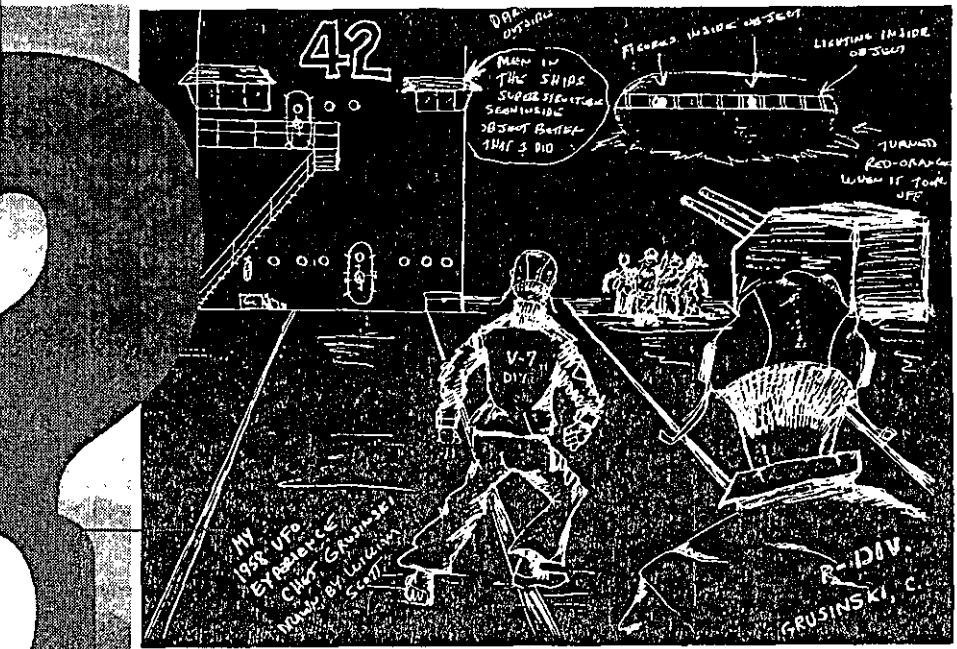
CHET GRUSINSKI, following his UFO sighting on the USS Roosevelt, uncovered a U.S. government document, including three photos, of a 1952 UFO incident on the same ship.

logs from that night have been mostly blacked out by military sensors. Plus, he ran across a separate U.S. government document with interesting notation about a 1952 UFO incident. Involving the Roosevelt: Three photographs of a flying disc were taken from

search of fellow eyewitnesses.

He even had one of his current co-workers, an artist, draw a detailed rendering of the 1958 UFO sighting. Grusinski is simultaneously working on a movie screenplay based on his experience. It's called "Out of the Sky."

WS, Warren, MI - Aug. 17, 1998 CR: C. Grusinski



An Artist's Rendering of Detroit Native Chet Grusinski's Possible UFO Sighting

Area Autoworker Is 'Mr. UFO'

By Gerald Scott
Staff Writer

Most people join the Navy to see the world.

Chet Grusinski joined the U.S. Navy in 1957 and saw something out of this world.

Grusinski, born in Hamtramck and raised in Detroit, was a 19-year-old fireman's apprentice serving aboard the aircraft carrier USS Franklin D. Roosevelt in 1958 when he says he saw a UFO. The object hovered over the ship and gave him and two dozen crew mates on deck an up-close and personal look at it, he says.

He's been in search of the truth about that unusual night ever since.

Grusinski, now 58, works as an automatic screw machine operator at H&L Tool Co. on Dequindre Road in Madison Heights.

He previously worked at the Ford Wixom assembly plant, Ford Dearborn stamping plant and Chrysler Mound Round engine plant.

"I get teasing at work about it, but I don't mind it," said Grusinski, who has become one of the Detroit area's foremost self-taught UFO experts. "They write stuff on my locker, but that's all right. They put on my locker 'Roswell Lives Here,' 'X-Files,' 'The Truth Is Out There,' 'Close Encounters' and then when I missed a day, they drew a crying alien face that says 'Chet, we miss you.'"

Grusinski has been researching UFOs, flying saucers and related phenomena

ever since that night in 1958, but over the last seven years, it has become his main outside hobby.

The study at his residence in Clinton Township is something of a UFO library, with all inanner of books, photographs, letters, documents and related research spread about.

But all it takes to understand Grusinski's passion for the subject is to listen to the detailed account of his UFO sighting, which took place aboard the USS Roosevelt in the Caribbean, out of the U.S. Navy base at Guantanamo Bay, Cuba.

Grusinski became one of 3,000 crewmen aboard the ship after it was overhauled at the New York Navy Shipyard.

It sailed from New York to Cuba and out of Guantanamo Bay in July 1958, when the young sailor from Detroit witnessed something extraordinary.

"We're out at sea. It was dark — 8 or 9 o'clock at night," he recalled. "We'd seen this little light following our ship."

"Then it came right at us. It came in close enough that I could see figures in there (inside the spacecraft)."

"By watching those figures,



CHET GRUSINSKI

the impression I got is that those were not human beings looking at us. I could see them that good. It was lit up inside of those windows, backlit, so I could see the silhouettes. The impression I got? They were not human," Grusinski said.

"I was kind of shocked because I wasn't expecting something like that.

Then, while we were looking at it, it turned a red-orange color and took off ... In the meantime, they were screaming for the officer of the deck on the intercom to get up there on the double.

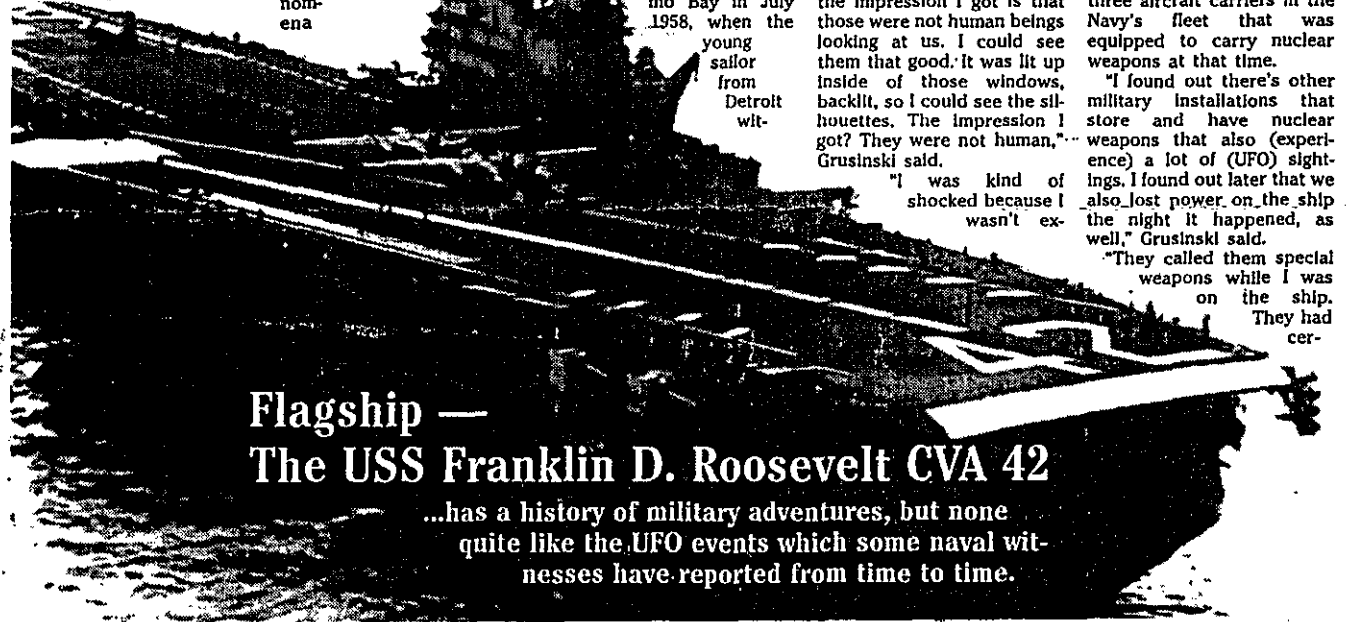
"It could've been a few minutes, or it might've been quite awhile — I've got no idea (how much time elapsed). But I could feel the heat on my face when it came up," he said. "It was cigar-shaped. It came up close to the island superstructure (on the carrier). Then it took off, and I went down below decks."

"The next day, I was drinking a lot of water. I felt like I was dehydrated," he said.

Grusinski's subsequent research into that night reveals some fascinating details, including the fact that the USS Roosevelt was one of only three aircraft carriers in the Navy's fleet that was equipped to carry nuclear weapons at that time.

"I found out there's other military installations that store and have nuclear weapons that also (experience) a lot of (UFO) sightings. I found out later that we also lost power on the ship the night it happened, as well," Grusinski said.

"They called them special weapons while I was on the ship. They had cer-



Flagship —
The USS Franklin D. Roosevelt CVA 42
...has a history of military adventures, but none quite like the UFO events which some naval witnesses have reported from time to time.

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